

9.3. The Device Manager

- m Start > Run and type in “devmgmt.msc”.
- m Right-click My Computer, click ‘Manage’, and then click ‘Device Manager’.
- m Right-click My Computer, click ‘Properties’, click the ‘Hardware’ tab, and then click ‘Device Manager’.
- m Type in the following at a command prompt: “start devmgmt.msc”

Device Manager provides a graphical view of the hardware installed on the computer, as well as the device drivers and resources associated with that hardware. Using Device Manager provides a central point to change the way the hardware is configured and interacts with the processor.

The appearance of the Device Manager will, naturally, depend on what devices are connected to your computer, but typically, the Device Manager looks something like the image on the right:

Typically, Device Manager is used to check the status of computer hardware and update device drivers on the computer. If you are an advanced user, and you have a thorough understanding of computer hardware, you can use Device Manager's diagnostic features to resolve device conflicts, and change resource settings.

So, say you've installed a new piece of hardware, such as a hard disk. The BIOS apart, the hard disk will show up in Device Manager. Similarly, if you connect a USB drive, it should show up



The Device Manager, expanded